Loaded Potato Soup

Serves 6

Ingredients

- Bacon, uncooked – 6 strips, cut into small pieces
- Butter, unsalted or salted – 3 Tablespoons
- Yellow Onion, chopped – 1 medium (about 1 1/2 cups/200g)
- Garlic – 3 large cloves, minced
- All-Purpose Flour – 1/3 cup (42g)
- Gold Potatoes, peeled and diced – 2 1/2 lbs (pieces no larger than 1”, about 6 large/1.15kg)
- Chicken Broth – 4 cups (945ml)
- Milk – 2 cups (475ml)
- Heavy Cream – 2/3 cup (155ml)
- Salt – 1 1/2 teaspoon* (see Notes)
- Ground Black Pepper – 1 teaspoon
- Ancho Chili Powder – 1/4–1/2 teaspoon** (see Notes)
- Sour Cream – 2/3 cup (160g)
- For Topping (optional) – Shredded cheddar cheese, chopped chives, additional sour cream, and crumbled bacon

Notes

* **Salt:** Start with 1 1/2 teaspoons, then taste and add more if needed. The amount will vary based on the brand of broth you use.

** **Ancho Chili Powder:** If you haven’t used it before, start with 1/4 teaspoon and taste the soup before adding up to 1/2 teaspoon, if you enjoy the flavor.

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Instructions

1. **Cook the Bacon**
   Place the bacon pieces in a large Dutch oven or soup pot over medium heat. Cook until crisp and browned. Remove the bacon pieces with a slotted spoon and set aside, leaving the rendered fat in the pot.

2. **Sauté Aromatics**
   Add the butter and chopped onion to the pot. Cook over medium heat, stirring occasionally, until the onions are tender (3–5 minutes). Add the minced garlic and cook until fragrant, about 30 seconds.

3. **Make the Roux**
   Sprinkle the flour over the onion mixture. Stir with a whisk or wooden spoon until smooth and no dry flour remains.

4. **Add Potatoes and Liquids**
   Add the diced potatoes, chicken broth, milk, heavy cream, salt, pepper, and ancho chili powder. Stir everything together well.

5. **Boil and Cook Potatoes**
   Bring the soup to a boil, then cook until the potatoes are tender when pierced with a fork, about 10 minutes.

6. **Blend Half the Soup**
   Reduce the heat to a simmer. Carefully remove about half of the soup (roughly 5 cups) to a blender. Purée until smooth, then return the puréed soup to the pot. (Alternatively, use an immersion blender directly in the pot to partially blend the soup, leaving some chunks.)

7. **Finish the Soup**
   Stir in the sour cream and the reserved bacon pieces. Let the soup simmer gently for 15 minutes before serving.

8. **Serve**
   Ladle into bowls and top with extra sour cream, bacon, cheddar cheese, and chives as desired. Enjoy!